National Weather Service
National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration

Weather Forecast Office
Hanford, CA
Monday, Oct 19, 2026

# Significant Pattern Change Next Week - Cooler and Wetter

## KEY POINTS

- **High confidence in a pattern change early next week.**
- **Temperatures well below average next week with moderate confidence of rain and high Sierra snow early Wednesday morning through Thursday.**

## WEATHER RISK OUTLOOK

Risk levels incorporate potential impacts from weather hazards and likelihood of occurrence for a reasonable worst-case scenario.

| | Mon 10/19 | Tue 10/20 | Wed 10/21 | Thu 10/22 | Fri 10/23 | Sat 10/24 | Sun 10/25 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **San Joaquin Valley** & Coastal Range | | | Rain | Rain | | | |
| **Sierra Nevada** & foothills | | | Rain Snow | Rain Snow | | | |
| **Kern County** Mountains & Desert | | | Wind Rain | Wind Rain | | | |

| Risk Levels | Little to None | Minor | Moderate | Major | Extreme |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

## DETAILS

### Kern County

**Wind**

**Impacts:**
Winds gusting near 40 mph. Blowing Dust.
**Timing:**
Late Tuesday through Thursday
**Confidence:**
Medium

**Details:**
Visibility may be reduced due to blowing dust before rain arrives late Tuesday into Wednesday.

**Heavy Rain**

**Impacts:**
Training rain showers and embedded thunderstorms through eastern Kern County.
**Timing:**
Wednesday
**Confidence:**
Low

**Details:**
Rain may be persistent enough to cause flash flooding on roadways, culverts and burn scars.

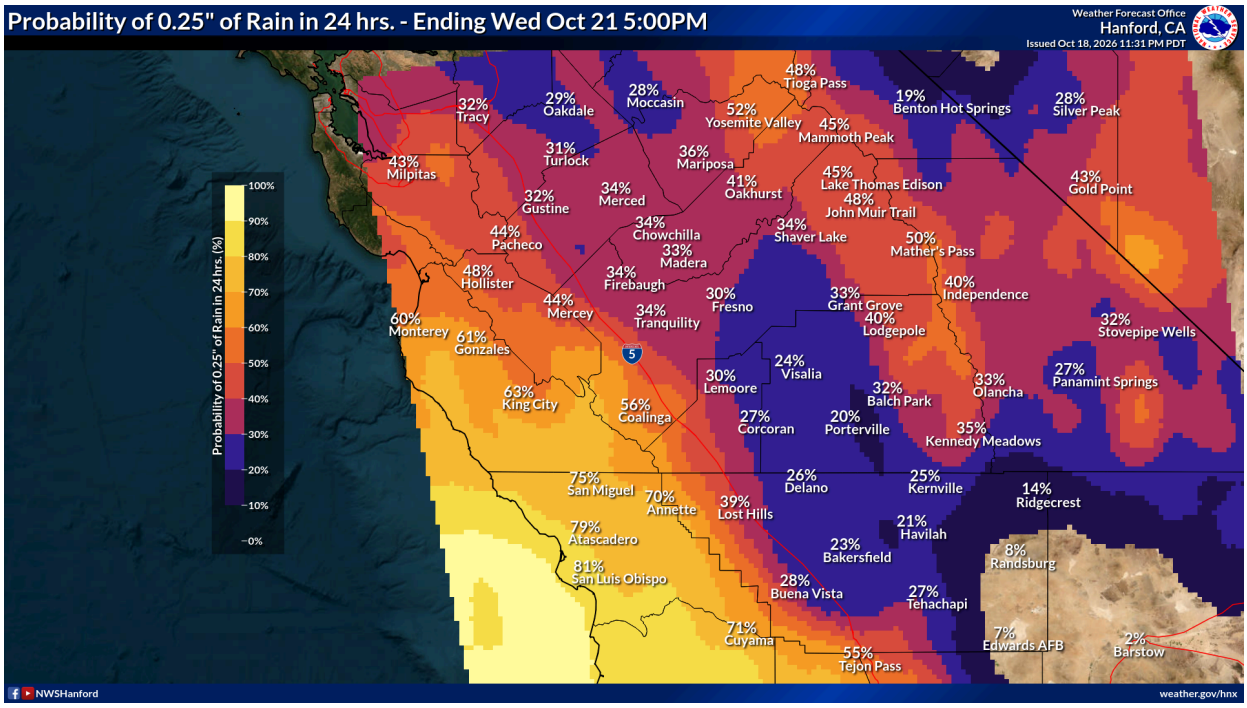
| Sierra Nevada | |
|---|---|
| Snow | **Impacts:**<br>40% Probability of 4" of Snow or more above 8000 feet<br>**Timing:**<br>Wednesday and Thursday<br>**Confidence:**<br>Medium |
| | **Details:**<br>Snow can make travel hazardous on any mountain passes still open over the Sierra Nevada, especially along Tioga Road/Pass. |

## FOR MORE INFORMATION

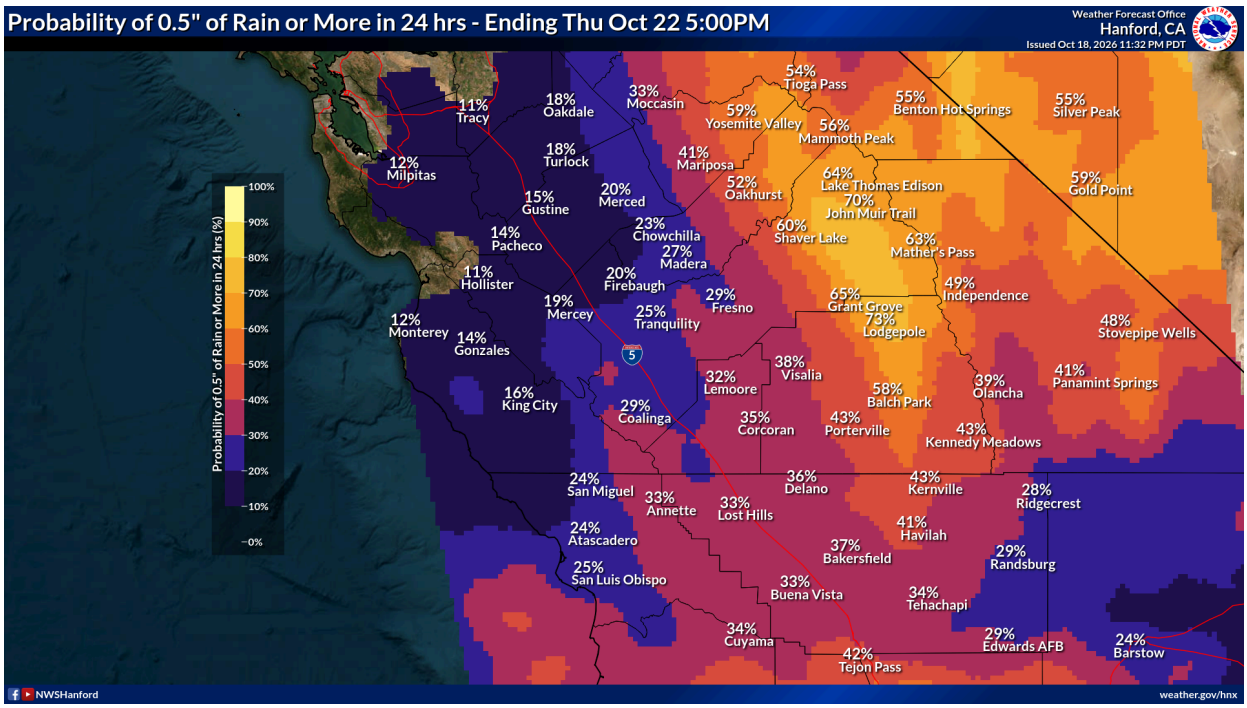
For the latest forecast updates, visit [weather.gov/hanford](weather.gov/hanford).

If you have questions or would like to submit weather reports, photos, or to unsubscribe from these briefings, email [nws.hanford@noaa.gov](mailto:nws.hanford@noaa.gov) or call **(559) 584-9051**.

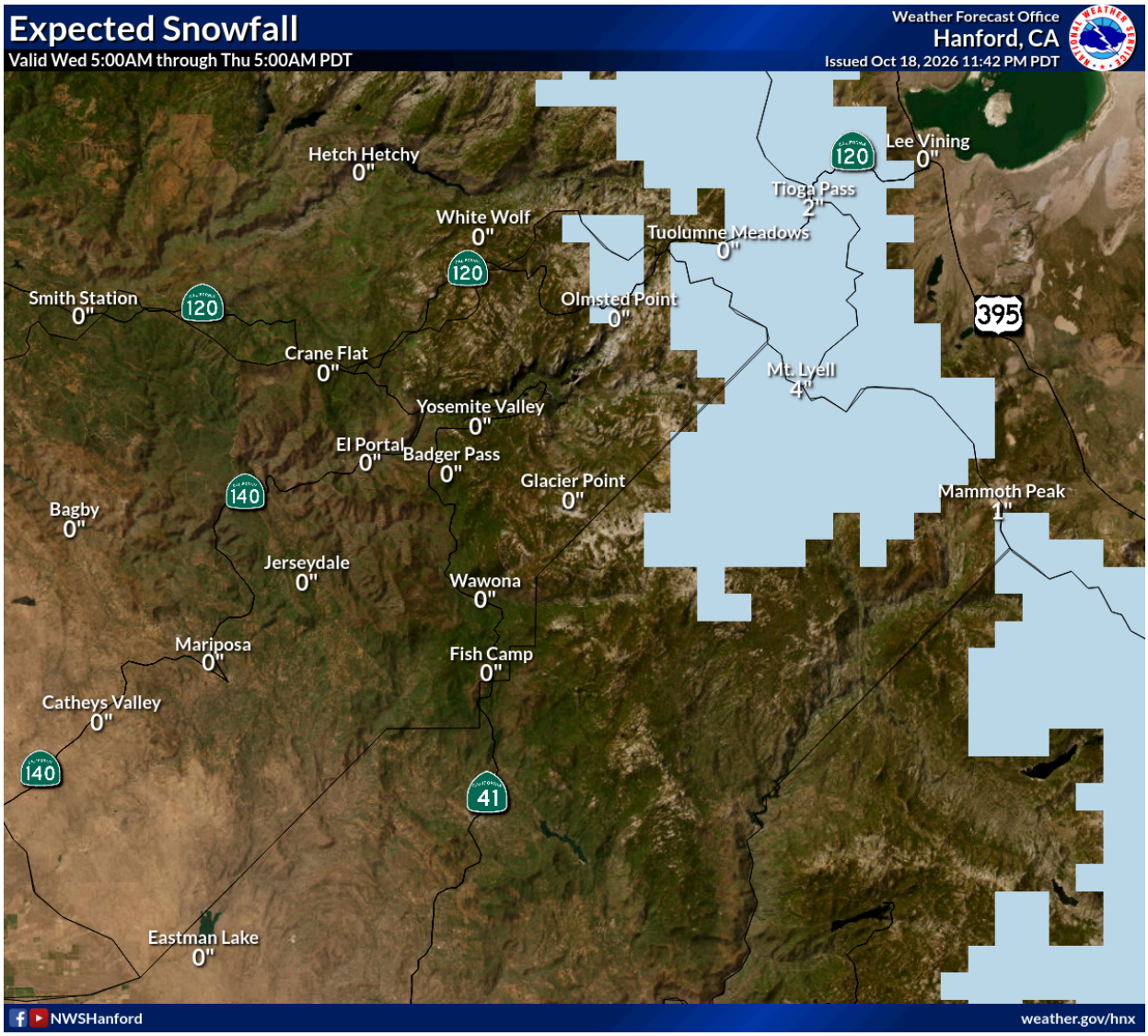
## GRAPHICS



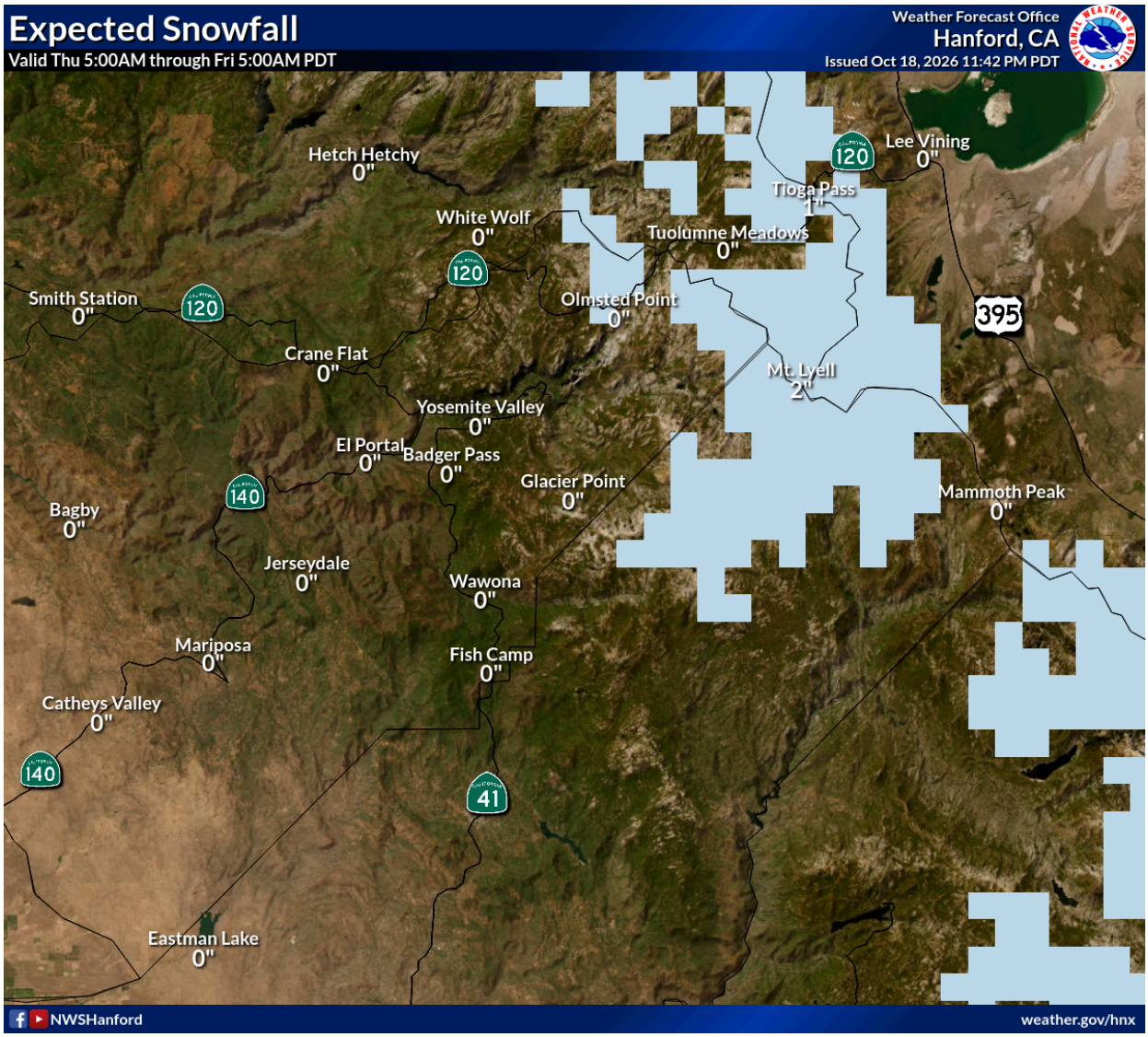

**Quarter Inch Rainfall Probabilities - Wednesday**




**Half Inch Rainfall Probabilities - Thursday**




**Expected Snowfall Totals - Wednesday**




**Expected Snowfall Totals - Thursday**